C♯ Minor

Scale Practice Worksheet · 4 sharps (F♯, C♯, G♯, D♯) · Relative minor of E major · 4 octaves

SCALES

01 Harmonic Minor — Parallel Motion

Play C♯ harmonic minor up and down in parallel motion across 4 octaves.

02 Harmonic Minor — Contrary Motion

Play C♯ harmonic minor in contrary motion — one hand ascending, one descending simultaneously.

03 Melodic Minor — Parallel Motion

Play C♯ melodic minor in parallel motion across 4 octaves. Descending, come back natural.

> **TIP**
> The important thing in this scale is remembering where you put your 4th finger in the right hand — place it on D♯. When descending, there is a temptation to use the 3rd finger instead, but then you will run out of fingers.

04 Scale in Tenths

Play C♯ harmonic minor in tenths (octave + third between hands).

05 Scale in Tenths — Melodic (Triplets)

Play C♯ melodic minor in tenths using triplet rhythm.

06 Scale in Sixths (Harmonic & Melodic)

Play the scale in sixths — this time moving the left hand while the right hand holds position. Start with the 5th finger. Play both the harmonic and melodic forms.

> **TIP**
> The interval of the 6th is the most complicated out of all of them. Start slowly in two octaves. Once comfortable, move to four octaves.

ARPEGGIOS & CHORDS — TONIC

07 Long Arpeggios

Play extended arpeggios of C♯ minor across the keyboard through all inversions. Repeat each inversion group as much as needed.

> **TIP**
> Train the 4th finger. Play legato. When practicing the left hand separately, add an extra note at a time to build it up gradually.

DOMINANT — G♯7

08 Dominant Chords

Play G♯7 solid chords to get familiar with the shape. To locate the dominant chord of any key, find the 5th degree of the scale — in C♯ minor, that's G♯.

09 Dominant Arpeggios

Play arpeggios of the G♯7 chord. In slow tempo, this is a good warm-up — it activates all your fingers.

> **TIP**
> Add rhythmic variations — prolong the 2nd note of each group, then the 3rd note.

10 **Dominant Broken Arpeggios**

Play G♯7 as a broken arpeggio.

11 **Dominant Long Arpeggios**

Play G♯7 as long arpeggios through all inversions. Choose a comfortable tempo. First inversion is more comfortable because you start from a white key.

TIP
Your thumb will most likely be lazy — pay attention to it. When you spot a problem, always slow down. Don't try to jump through it. Slow down and detect what's happening.

DIMINISHED — B♯ DIM

12 **Diminished Chords**

Built on the 7th degree: **B♯ – D♯ – F♯** (all minor thirds; B♯ is enharmonically C). Play the octave with very active middle voices — play, then grab.

13 **Diminished Arpeggios**

Play arpeggios of the diminished chord. Hands move in a circular motion — use rotation to reach the notes rather than stretching for the keys.

14 **Diminished Broken Arpeggios**

Play the diminished chord as a broken arpeggio.

15 **Diminished Long Arpeggios**

Play long arpeggios of the diminished chord through all inversions. Take this slowly.

TECHNIQUE

Instead of rotating, move very quickly between notes with the smallest possible disconnection. It should look and sound legato, but the movement between positions is so fast and small you cannot hear the gap. 2nd inversion starts from F#.

TIP

Practice left hand only — it immediately exposes unintended accents and connection problems between the 4th finger and thumb. Move quicker between positions to clean up the line.

VARIATIONS

Contrary Motion

Any scale or arpeggio exercise can be played in contrary motion — one hand ascending while the other descends simultaneously. This is harder than parallel motion and excellent brain training.

Accent & Rhythmic Variations

Apply to any scale or arpeggio exercise for fluidity and evenness:

a Accent every note — extra weight on each individual note.

b Accent every second note — grouped, rolling feel.

c Triplet groupings — organize the scale in groups of three.

d Groups of four — organize the scale in groups of four.

e Prolong one note per group — hold the 2nd or 3rd note slightly longer to build control.

Staccato

Any scale exercise can be played staccato — lift from each key rather than connecting the notes. Treat it as a separate pass, not a replacement for legato practice.

GENERAL PRACTICE PRINCIPLES

- Start slow, increase tempo gradually
- Move with your hands instead of reaching for the keys
- Practice left hand separately — it reveals weaknesses the right hand covers
- Play legato — aim for a connected, even sound